

Standard Operating Procedures — Employee Handbook

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This handbook contains all Standard Operating Procedures (SOPs) for TechCorp Solutions employees. It covers leave management, customer complaint handling, data privacy, employee onboarding, and expense reimbursement. All employees are required to read and follow these procedures.

1. Leave Management Policy

1.1 Leave Application Process

The leave application process at TechCorp Solutions is designed to be simple and transparent. Employees must submit leave requests at least 3 working days in advance for planned leave.

- Step 1: Log in to the HR portal at hr.techcorp.com using your employee credentials.
- Step 2: Navigate to Leave Management and click on Apply for Leave.
- Step 3: Select the leave type: Casual Leave, Sick Leave, Earned Leave, or Maternity/Paternity Leave.
- Step 4: Enter the start date and end date. Add a reason in the comments field.
- Step 5: Submit the request. Your reporting manager will receive an automatic email notification.
- Step 6: Track approval status in the HR portal under My Leave Requests.

1.2 Leave Types and Entitlements

Each employee is entitled to the following leave types per calendar year:

- Casual Leave (CL): 12 days per year. Can be taken in single or multiple days. Cannot be carried forward.
- Sick Leave (SL): 10 days per year. Medical certificate required for more than 2 consecutive days.
- Earned Leave (EL): 18 days per year. Accumulated at 1.5 days per month. Can be carried forward up to 30 days.
- Maternity Leave: 26 weeks for female employees as per Maternity Benefit Act.
- Paternity Leave: 5 days for male employees within 6 months of child birth.

1.3 Leave Approval Authority

Leave approval follows a defined hierarchy to ensure business continuity:

- Up to 3 days: Approved by direct reporting manager.
- 4 to 10 days: Approved by reporting manager and department head.
- More than 10 days: Approved by HR Manager and Business Unit Head.

- Emergency leave: Employee must inform manager via phone/WhatsApp. Formal application within 24 hours of return.

1.4 Leave Cancellation

To cancel an approved leave, the employee must submit a cancellation request in the HR portal at least one day before the leave start date. Cancellations after the leave start date require HR approval.

2. Customer Complaint Handling Procedure

2.1 How to Handle a Customer Complaint

Every customer complaint must be treated as a priority. The first point of contact is responsible for acknowledging the complaint within 2 hours of receipt.

- Step 1: Acknowledge — Respond to the customer within 2 hours. Use the standard template in CRM.
- Step 2: Log the complaint — Enter all details in the CRM system under Customer Complaints module.
- Step 3: Categorise — Tag as Billing Issue, Technical Issue, Service Delay, Product Defect, or Other.
- Step 4: Assign — Route to the relevant department based on category.
- Step 5: Resolve — Provide resolution within SLA timeline. Update CRM with resolution details.
- Step 6: Follow up — Contact customer 24 hours after resolution to confirm satisfaction.

2.2 Escalation Process for Customer Complaints

If a complaint cannot be resolved at the first level within the defined SLA, it must be escalated immediately. Failure to escalate within the defined time will result in SLA breach and performance impact.

- Level 1 — Support Executive: Resolve within 4 working hours for standard complaints.
- Level 2 — Team Lead: Escalate if unresolved after 4 hours. Team Lead has 8 hours to resolve.
- Level 3 — Customer Success Manager: Escalate if unresolved after 12 hours. Must personally call the customer.
- Level 4 — VP Customer Experience: Escalate for VIP clients or legal threats. Immediate action required.

2.3 SLA Timelines

- Critical (Service Down, Legal Threat): Respond in 1 hour, resolve in 4 hours.
 - High (Billing Error, Data Loss): Respond in 2 hours, resolve in 8 hours.
 - Medium (Feature Request, Delay): Respond in 4 hours, resolve in 2 business days.
 - Low (General Query, Feedback): Respond in 8 hours, resolve in 5 business days.
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3. Data Privacy and Information Security Policy

3.1 Data Privacy Rules

TechCorp Solutions is committed to protecting customer and employee data in compliance with applicable data protection laws including GDPR, IT Act 2000, and DPDP Act 2023. All employees must follow these rules strictly.

- Rule 1: Never share customer personal data (name, email, phone, address) with third parties without written consent.
- Rule 2: Customer data must only be accessed on need-to-know basis. Log all data access in the system.
- Rule 3: Never download customer data to personal devices or personal email accounts.
- Rule 4: All laptops must have full-disk encryption enabled. Report lost devices to IT within 1 hour.
- Rule 5: Passwords must be at least 12 characters with uppercase, lowercase, numbers and symbols. Change every 90 days.
- Rule 6: Do not use public Wi-Fi for company work without VPN. Company VPN must be active at all times.
- Rule 7: Data breach or suspicious activity must be reported to the Data Protection Officer within 30 minutes.

3.2 Data Classification

- Confidential: Customer PII, financial data, contracts — restricted to authorized roles only.
- Internal: Company policies, internal reports — shared only within the organization.
- Public: Marketing material, published documents — can be shared externally.

3.3 Consequences of Data Privacy Violation

Violation of data privacy rules is treated as a serious misconduct. Consequences include:

- First violation: Written warning and mandatory data privacy retraining.
- Second violation: Suspension and investigation by HR and Legal.
- Intentional breach or malicious intent: Immediate termination and legal action.

4. Employee Onboarding Procedure

4.1 Steps to Onboard a New Employee

The onboarding process begins 7 days before the joining date. HR, IT, Admin, and the hiring manager are all responsible for different parts of the onboarding process.

- Step 1 (7 days before joining): HR sends offer letter, onboarding kit link, and document checklist to candidate.
- Step 2 (5 days before joining): IT creates employee email ID, laptop, system access, and VPN credentials.

- Step 3 (3 days before joining): Admin arranges workstation, ID card, and access card.
- Step 4 (1 day before joining): Hiring manager assigns buddy/mentor for the first 30 days.
- Step 5 (Day 1 — Morning): HR conducts company orientation: culture, policies, org structure, benefits.
- Step 6 (Day 1 — Afternoon): IT gives system walkthrough: laptop setup, email, tools, VPN, Slack.
- Step 7 (Day 2-5): Department-specific training with team lead. Shadow existing team members.
- Step 8 (Day 30): Manager conducts 30-day check-in. Review onboarding experience and set 60-day goals.

4.2 Documents Required from New Employee

- Identity Proof: Aadhaar card, PAN card, Passport (any two)
- Address Proof: Utility bill or bank statement (not older than 3 months)
- Educational Certificates: All degree certificates and marksheets
- Experience Letters: From all previous employers
- Bank Account Details: For salary processing (cancelled cheque or passbook copy)
- PF and ESI details: UAN number if previously employed

4.3 Probation Period Policy

All new employees undergo a probation period of 6 months. During probation:

- Monthly performance reviews conducted by reporting manager.
- Employee is not eligible for promotion, internal transfer, or long leave.
- Notice period during probation is 2 weeks (vs 2 months post-confirmation).
- Confirmation letter issued after successful completion of probation.

5. Expense Reimbursement Policy

5.1 Who Approves Expense Reimbursement

Expense reimbursement approval is based on the expense amount and the employee's grade level. All expense claims must be submitted within 30 days of incurring the expense.

- Up to Rs. 5,000: Approved by direct reporting manager.
- Rs. 5,001 to Rs. 25,000: Approved by reporting manager and department head.
- Rs. 25,001 to Rs. 1,00,000: Approved by department head and Finance Manager.
- Above Rs. 1,00,000: Approved by Finance Manager and CFO.
- Travel expenses above Rs. 50,000: Requires pre-approval before the trip.

5.2 Expense Reimbursement Process

- Step 1: Collect all original receipts and bills for the expenses incurred.
- Step 2: Log in to the Finance portal at finance.techcorp.com.

- Step 3: Navigate to Expense Claims and click Submit New Claim.
- Step 4: Upload scanned copies of all receipts. Fill in expense date, category, and amount.
- Step 5: Submit for approval. Your manager receives an automatic notification.
- Step 6: Approved amount is credited to your bank account within 7 working days.

5.3 Eligible and Ineligible Expenses

The following expenses are eligible for reimbursement:

- Travel: Flight, train, cab fares for official business trips with prior approval.
- Accommodation: Hotel stays during official travel. Economy class hotels only.
- Client Entertainment: Meals and entertainment for clients up to Rs. 3,000 per person.
- Office Supplies: Stationery and supplies purchased for official use.
- Training: Course fees and certification costs approved by HR and manager.

The following expenses are NOT eligible for reimbursement:

- Personal expenses, alcohol, tobacco, or luxury items.
- Expenses without original receipts or bills.
- Expenses older than 30 days from submission date.
- Travel upgrades (business class or premium hotels) without prior CFO approval.

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